

Prompt Engineering for AI Video Generation

EX-9 | PRACTICAL EXPLORATION

This document explores how different prompt structures — from simple one-liners to richly detailed descriptions — affect the quality, coherence, and artistic style of AI-generated videos. Through hands-on experimentation with leading AI video tools, learners will develop practical skills in prompt engineering.

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Objective of This Exercise

The primary goal of this exercise is to **demonstrate how different prompt structures affect AI-generated video outputs**. By comparing simple and detailed prompts, learners gain insight into the mechanics of prompt engineering and its direct impact on video quality, narrative coherence, and visual style.

1

Create Prompts

Design both simple and detailed prompts for AI video generation tools.

2

Generate Videos

Use recommended AI tools to produce videos from your prompts.

3

Compare Outputs

Analyze differences in quality, coherence, and style between outputs.

Analyze Effectiveness

Evaluate which prompt engineering techniques yield the best results.



What is Prompt Engineering?

Definition

Prompt engineering is the practice of crafting precise, structured text inputs to guide AI models toward producing desired outputs. In video generation, a well-engineered prompt acts as a creative brief for the AI.

Why It Matters for Video

AI video models interpret natural language to generate visual content. The more specific and structured your prompt, the more accurately the AI can render your vision. Vague prompts produce unpredictable results, while detailed prompts give the model clear direction on subject, style, motion, and mood.

- Controls subject matter and scene composition
- Defines artistic style and visual tone
- Guides camera movement and pacing
- Reduces unwanted artifacts and inconsistencies



Simple vs. Detailed Prompts

The structure and richness of a prompt directly determines the quality of the generated video. Understanding the difference between simple and detailed prompts is the foundation of effective prompt engineering.



Simple Prompt

Example: *"A dog running."*

Simple prompts provide minimal context. The AI fills in the gaps with default assumptions, often resulting in generic, inconsistent, or low-quality outputs. The breed, environment, lighting, and camera angle are all left to chance.



Detailed Prompt

Example: *"A golden retriever running through a sunlit forest at golden hour, cinematic slow motion, shallow depth of field, warm tones."*

Detailed prompts specify subject, setting, lighting, camera style, and mood — giving the AI clear creative direction for a polished, coherent result.

Anatomy of a Strong Video Prompt

Effective video prompts follow a structured formula. Each component adds a layer of control, narrowing the AI's interpretation toward your intended vision.

1**Subject**

Who or what is in the scene?
Be specific about the main
focus.

2**Action**

What is happening? Describe
the movement or event clearly.

3**Setting**

Where does it take place?
Define the environment and
background.

4**Style**

What is the visual aesthetic?
Cinematic, anime,
photorealistic?

5**Technical**

Camera angles, lighting,
resolution, and motion
descriptors.

 **Pro Tip:** Combine all five elements into one flowing sentence for best results. Example: *"A young woman (subject) dancing gracefully (action) on a rooftop at sunset (setting), in the style of a French New Wave film (style), shot on 35mm with soft natural light (technical)."*

Suggested AI Video Generation Tools

The following platforms are recommended for this exercise. Each has unique strengths in prompt interpretation, video quality, and ease of use.

**RunwayML****Pika Labs****Synthesia**

A professional-grade tool with advanced text-to-video and image-to-video capabilities. Offers fine-grained control over motion and style. Ideal for cinematic outputs.



Kaiber AI

Focuses on artistic and stylized video generation. Excellent for music videos, abstract visuals, and creative storytelling with strong aesthetic control.

A user-friendly platform known for generating high-quality short videos from simple text prompts. Great for beginners and rapid prototyping.



Canva AI Video

An accessible, all-in-one design platform with integrated AI video tools. Perfect for students and non-technical users seeking quick, polished results.

Specializes in AI avatar-based videos. Ideal for educational and corporate content where a human presenter is needed without filming.

Step-by-Step: Generating Your First AI Video

Follow this workflow to generate your first AI video and begin comparing prompt techniques.

Choose Tool

Select RunwayML, Pika, or similar



Generate & Review

Run the model and assess output



Write Prompt

Craft a clear, structured description



Iterate & Refine

Adjust prompt and regenerate



Each iteration teaches you something new about how the AI interprets language. Keep a log of your prompts and results — this becomes your personal prompt engineering reference guide.

Before You Start

- Create a free account on your chosen platform
- Familiarize yourself with the interface
- Prepare a notepad for logging experiments

Best Practices

- Start simple, then add detail incrementally
- Test one variable at a time
- Compare outputs side by side

Comparison: Simple vs. Detailed Prompt Outputs

The table below illustrates how the same concept produces dramatically different results when prompted simply versus in detail. Use this as a reference when designing your own experiments.

Aspect	Simple Prompt	Detailed Prompt
Subject Clarity	Generic, may misinterpret the subject	Precise subject with specific attributes
Background	Random or default environment	Defined setting matching the narrative

Lighting	Inconsistent, often flat	Controlled mood (golden hour, neon, etc.)
Camera Style	Default angle, no movement	Specified shots (wide, close-up, tracking)
Visual Coherence	May have artifacts or glitches	Smooth, consistent, and polished
Artistic Style	Unpredictable aesthetic	Matches the intended genre or mood

Analyzing Prompt Effectiveness

After generating videos with both simple and detailed prompts, use the following framework to evaluate and compare your results systematically.

Quality Assessment

Evaluate resolution, sharpness, and absence of visual artifacts. Does the video look professional or amateur? Note any distortions, flickering, or unnatural movements that reduce quality.

Coherence Check

Does the video maintain logical consistency throughout? Check if the subject, setting, and action remain stable across frames. Incoherent videos often show objects morphing or scenes shifting unexpectedly.

Style Alignment

Does the output match the intended artistic style? If you requested a "cinematic noir" look, does the video deliver moody lighting and

Prompt-Output Gap

Identify what the AI got right and what it missed. This gap analysis helps you refine future prompts. Document specific phrases

dramatic contrast? Style alignment is a key

that worked well and those that were ignored

- ✓ **Key Finding:** Detailed prompts consistently outperform simple prompts across all evaluation criteria. The additional effort in crafting structured prompts yields significantly more controllable and professional video outputs.

Key Takeaways & Conclusion

This exercise demonstrates that **prompt engineering is a skill, not a guess**. The quality of AI-generated video is directly proportional to the clarity, structure, and specificity of the prompt provided.



Prompts Are Creative Briefs

Treat every prompt as a director's brief — the more detail you provide, the better the AI performs.



Comparison Drives Learning

Side-by-side analysis of simple vs. detailed outputs is the fastest way to understand AI behavior.



Tool Choice Matters

Different platforms interpret prompts differently. Experiment across tools to find your best fit.



Iterate to Improve

Every failed or imperfect output is a learning opportunity. Refine, retest, and document your findings.

"The AI is only as good as the question you ask it. Master the prompt, and you master the output."

Like what you created?

+ Create something else

↶ Back to prompt

Help refine our product

How satisfied are you with the output?



Hide